

# HERD HEALTH PLAN

M J Hunt & Son | Upper Assendon Farm, Stonor, Henley-on-Thames, Oxfordshire

Prepared by Larkmead Vets | Review date: July 2026

|                        |                                                                                                |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Date of current review | July 2026                                                                                      |
| Date for next review   | July 2027                                                                                      |
| TB status              | Under restriction — ongoing. Last test: clear skin test 2025; slaughterhouse cases identified. |
| IBR                    | No recent testing — health & performance figures good                                          |
| BVD                    | Youngstock check test completed autumn 2025 — negative                                         |
| Lepto                  | No recent testing — low clinical risk                                                          |
| Johnes                 | Clear                                                                                          |
| Farm assurance         | Red Tractor. SAI Global (beef). SFI agreements UAF332270030 and M J Hunt & Son 24.             |
| Nutritionist           | NA                                                                                             |
| Foot trimmer           | DIY on farm                                                                                    |

|                           |                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nominated vet — signature | <b>Adelle Jenkins BVSc GPcertFAP MRCVS</b><br>Larkmead Veterinary Group<br>Date: July 2026<br><br>Signature: _____ |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## 1. Farm Details

|               |                                                                     |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Farmer        | James Hunt                                                          |
| Business      | M J Hunt & Son                                                      |
| Address       | Upper Assendon Farm, Stonor, Henley-on-Thames, Oxfordshire, RG9 6HE |
| CPH number    | 33/227/0030                                                         |
| Contact       | James Hunt — 07989 294737 (text/email preferred)                    |
| Vet practice  | Larkmead Veterinary Group                                           |
| Nominated vet | Adelle Jenkins BVSc GPcertFAP MRCVS                                 |

|                         |                                     |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Emergency vet           | Larkmead out-of-hours service       |
| Medicines administrator | James Hunt                          |
| Health plan prepared by | Adelle Jenkins BVSc GPcertFAP MRCVS |

## 2. Stock Numbers and Production Aims

| Category                | Detail                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bulls                   | 2 senior + 5 junior Wagyu (all homebred)                                                                                           |
| Cows & breeding heifers | 65 — predominantly Wagyu breeding. Building towards a more uniform Wagyu herd for consistency in marbling of the finished product. |
| Followers               | Approximately 80                                                                                                                   |
| Other enterprises       | Arable — 480ha (1,188ac), 52 RPA parcels                                                                                           |

|                    |                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Production aim     | Produce 60–65 Wagyu X calves per year and take through to finish under the Warrendale scheme. Building herd uniformity to maximise marbling scores and direct marketing potential. |
| Capital investment | New slurry store under consideration. No other major capital investments planned.                                                                                                  |

## 3. Disease Status Overview

| Disease         | Status            | Notes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TB              | Under restriction | 20 reactors in last 12 months — a problem group of youngstock, now all slaughtered. Last skin test clear. Slaughterhouse cases found in animals sent to slaughter. Some high-risk grazing continues. Review risk management with vet.                                     |
| Copper toxicity | Ongoing concern   | PM summer 2024 showed liver changes consistent with copper toxicity. Clinical cases (scour, poor condition) in spring 2025 — no deaths. Management: minerals raised off ground when calves young; consider magnesium-only licks for cows. Monitor in 2026 calving season. |
| BVD             | Negative          | Youngstock check test completed autumn 2025 — negative. Next check test due autumn 2026 when youngstock reach correct age.                                                                                                                                                |
| IBR             | Low risk          | No recent testing. Health and performance figures good — infectious disease unlikely to be a factor. Test as necessary after vet discussion.                                                                                                                              |
| Lepto           | Low risk          | No recent testing. No clinical signs.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Johnes          | Clear             | No cases identified.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

| Disease            | Status   | Notes                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lice               | Absent   | No evidence                                                                                                                                  |
| Liver fluke        | Absent   | No routine treatment — no signs. Chiltern chalk soils low risk.                                                                              |
| Internal parasites | Low risk | No anthelmintics used for 10+ years. No signs or evidence of disease. FWEC (faecal worm egg counts) carried out July and September annually. |
| Digital dermatitis | Absent   |                                                                                                                                              |

## 4. Herd Health Priorities 2026

### 4.1 TB Management

TB remains an active breakdown on the farm. The last skin test was clear but slaughterhouse cases were identified in animals sent to slaughter prior to the test. A problem group of youngstock (20 reactors in the last 12 months) have now all been slaughtered.

Some high-risk grazing areas continue to be grazed as this cannot currently be avoided. Actions:

- Continue strict compliance with APHA guidance and movement restrictions
- Immediate isolation of any reactor
- All animals consigned direct to slaughter under Warrendale scheme — no disruption to normal business operations
- Consider risk map with vet to identify fields of highest risk and manage grazing rotation accordingly
- Review whether any badger activity hotspots can be mitigated with fencing

### 4.2 Copper Toxicity in Pre-Weaned Calves

Copper toxicity has been identified as an issue for 2-3 years. Post-mortem examination summer 2024 showed liver changes consistent with copper accumulation. Clinical cases (scouring, poor condition, thin calves) were seen in spring 2025 — no deaths this year.

Management measures implemented for 2026:

- Minerals raised off the ground when calves are very young to reduce access
- Magnesium-only licks used for cows during early calf period (under consideration)
- Monitor calves closely in 2026 calving season — early intervention if signs of ill-thrift
- Consider liver biopsy/PM if further cases seen to confirm copper levels

## 5. Herd Calendar

|          |       |                                                                                                      |                         |
|----------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| January  | Cows  | Late Jan — calving starts. Monitor closely for copper toxicity in calves. Raise minerals off ground. |                         |
| February | Bulls | MOT — check feet, BCS (ideally 4), palpate testicles.                                                | Consider semen testing. |

|           |                                 |                                                                                           |                                                                                     |
|-----------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| March     | Cows                            | Late March — finish calving. Address lame cows or poor feet. Check copper toxicity cases. | Vet check cows that had assisted calvings pre-breeding.                             |
| April     | Bulls                           | Final pre-breeding bull checks. Confirm all in good health and condition.                 |                                                                                     |
| May       | Whole herd                      | Bulls in. Watch for bulling activity.                                                     |                                                                                     |
| June      | Cows                            | Observe bulling activity — should be getting quiet. Yearlings to pasture.                 |                                                                                     |
| July      | Bulls out<br>Yearlings & calves | Bulls out. FWEC on yearlings and calves.                                                  | Faecal worm egg counts (FWEC). BVD youngstock check test if animals at correct age. |
| August    | Cows                            | Herd health plan annual review due. TB test if due.                                       | Annual HHP review with vet.                                                         |
| September | Yearlings & calves              | FWEC. Prepare yearlings for housing.                                                      | Faecal worm egg counts.                                                             |
| October   | Whole herd                      | TB test if required. Housing.                                                             | TB skin test as required by APHA schedule.                                          |
| November  | Cows                            | Monitor BCS ahead of calving season. Adjust diet if needed.                               |                                                                                     |
| December  | Whole herd                      | BVD blood sampling. Pregnancy diagnosis cows. Pre-calving mineral programme review.       | BVD testing. PD.                                                                    |

## 6. Health & Performance Review

| Condition                  | No. cases   | No. dead | Threshold | Notes                                                |
|----------------------------|-------------|----------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Infectious diseases</b> |             |          |           |                                                      |
| BVD                        | 0           | —        | —         | Negative check test autumn 2025                      |
| TB                         | 20 reactors | —        | —         | Ongoing breakdown — youngstock group all slaughtered |
| IBR / Lepto                | 0           | —        | —         | No clinical signs                                    |
| Johnes                     | 0           | —        | —         | Clear                                                |

| Condition            | No. cases | No. dead | Threshold | Notes                                                    |
|----------------------|-----------|----------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cow specific</b>  |           |          |           |                                                          |
| Abortion             | 0         | 0        | >2%       | Well within threshold                                    |
| Difficult calving    | 4         | 0        | <5%       | Within threshold for herd size                           |
| Barren cows          | 1         | —        | >7%       |                                                          |
| Mastitis             | 1         | 0        | >3%       | Very rare — seek vet advice if further cases             |
| Lameness             | 0         | —        | —         | In-house foot trimming as required                       |
| <b>Calf specific</b> |           |          |           |                                                          |
| Pneumonia            | 0         | 0        | <5%       |                                                          |
| Scour                | 0         | 0        | >5%       |                                                          |
| Ill-thrift / copper  | 3         | 0        | >5%       | Suspected copper toxicity — management measures in place |

## 7. Antimicrobial Use

|                                                          |                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Medicines purchased (12 months to July 2026)</b>      | Zero medicines purchased from Larkmead Vets       |
| <b>Antimicrobial use (AMU)</b>                           | 0 mg/kg PCU                                       |
| <b>Highest Priority Critically Important antibiotics</b> | Not prescribed on this farm in the last 12 months |
| <b>Prophylactic antibiotic use</b>                       | None in last 12 months                            |
| <b>Medicines under veterinary cascade</b>                | Not applicable                                    |

Recommendation: No antibiotic purchases — no further AMU recommendations. Zero use is an excellent outcome and reflects the low disease burden of this herd. Continue to maintain this standard.

## 8. Purchase Policy and Biosecurity

The only cattle being purchased are replacement stock bulls that come through the Wagyu scheme from high health status farms. Recommended health status requirements for purchased bulls:

| Disease | Requirement                                                 |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| BVD     | High health herd scheme accredited. Tag and tested ideally. |

| Disease | Requirement                                                                               |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lepto   | High health herd scheme accredited. Annual blood testing.                                 |
| IBR     | High health herd scheme accredited. Annual blood testing.                                 |
| Johnes  | High health herd scheme accredited. Annual blood testing.                                 |
| TB      | No TB in herd or neighbouring for at least 24 months. Check IBTB website before purchase. |

Full biosecurity protocols, quarantine procedures, and general biosecurity are contained in the separate Biosecurity, Legislation & Euthanasia SOPs document (reviewed 2025).

## 9. Routine Husbandry Policies

### 9.1 Pain Relief Policy

Metacam (meloxicam) is given to any animal showing signs of pain, swelling, inflammation — particularly in cases of lameness, pneumonia, or post-calving complications.

### 9.2 Colostrum Policy

Observed suckling. Wagyu calves are vigorous and calving difficulties are very rare. Rule of thumb: 20 minutes sustained suckling within the first 6 hours of life ensures adequate colostrum intake. Vet SOP golden rule: 3 litres within 6 hours, 3 litres in the next 6 hours (6 litres within 12 hours).

### 9.3 TB Reactor Policy

Reactors are immediately isolated and APHA guidance is followed. All animals go direct to slaughter under the Warrendale scheme — no disruption to normal business operations.

### 9.4 Castration and Disbudding

- Castration: rubber ring in first 7 days of age. NSAIDs and local anaesthetic required.
- Disbudding: hot iron under local anaesthetic and NSAIDs.
- Burdizzo castration can only be used in calves under 2 months. Surgical castration over 2 months — vet only.

### 9.5 Identification of Treated Animals

Details entered on computer software (Farm Hub medicine records) and in the farm records book.

## 10. Record of Farmer Training

| Course                        | Attendee   | Date | Deliverer |
|-------------------------------|------------|------|-----------|
| Medicines training (5-yearly) | James Hunt |      |           |
|                               |            |      |           |

Note: Medicines course attendance is required every 5 years. Confirm date with James and book if due.

## 11. Declaration

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*I confirm that this Herd Health Plan is accurate and that the practices described are being followed on this farm.*

**Farmer name: James Hunt**

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Farmer signature: \_\_\_\_\_

**Vet name: Adelle Jenkins BVSc GPcertFAP MRCVS**

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Vet signature: \_\_\_\_\_